



Budget & Finance Planner

Take Control of Your Money, One Month at a Time

12 MONTHLY BUDGETS

EXPENSE TRACKER

DEBT PAYOFF

SAVINGS GOALS

FOR INDIVIDUALS, COUPLES & FAMILIES

MORE SHINE PRESS

This Planner Belongs To

BUDGETING PERIOD

PRIMARY FINANCIAL GOAL

TARGET SAVINGS THIS YEAR

MY MONEY MOTTO

How to Use This Planner

Your roadmap to financial peace of mind

WHY BUDGET?

A budget is not about restriction — it is about intention. When you tell your money where to go instead of wondering where it went, you gain control, reduce stress, and accelerate toward the things that matter most to you. This planner gives you the tools to do exactly that.

Six Steps to Financial Control

- 1. Set your goals.** Before the numbers, know your "why." Write down your short-term, mid-term, and long-term financial goals. They will guide every budgeting decision.
- 2. Track your income.** List every source of income — salary, side hustles, investments, and anything else. Knowing your total inflow is the foundation of every budget.
- 3. List your expenses.** Start with fixed costs (rent, insurance, debt payments), then estimate variable costs (groceries, dining, entertainment). Track daily for the first month to get real numbers.
- 4. Build your budget.** Allocate every dollar. Prioritize needs first, then savings, then wants. The goal is to spend less than you earn — every month.
- 5. Track and adjust.** Record actual spending against your plan weekly. Adjust as needed. A budget that does not bend will break — flexibility is part of the process.
- 6. Review and celebrate.** At month-end, review what worked. Celebrate wins, learn from misses, and refine your plan. Every month gets easier.

The 50/30/20 Rule: A popular starting point — allocate roughly 50% to needs, 30% to wants, and 20% to savings and debt repayment. Adjust based on your situation.

Budgeting Methods

Find the approach that works for you

50/30/20 Rule	BEST FOR: BEGINNERS
The simplest framework. 50% of income goes to needs (housing, food, insurance, minimum debt payments). 30% to wants (dining, entertainment, hobbies). 20% to savings and extra debt payments. Best for beginners who want a quick, flexible guideline.	
Zero-Based Budget	BEST FOR: DETAIL-ORIENTED PLANNERS
Every dollar is assigned a job before the month begins. Income minus expenses equals exactly zero. Forces you to be intentional with every dollar. More work but maximum control.	
Envelope System	BEST FOR: OVERSPENDERS
Allocate cash into labeled envelopes for each spending category. When an envelope is empty, that category is done for the month. Prevents overspending. Can be adapted digitally.	
Pay Yourself First	BEST FOR: SAVERS WHO STRUGGLE TO SAVE
Automatically route savings off the top, then budget with what remains. Treats savings as a non-negotiable expense rather than an afterthought.	
Incremental Budget	BEST FOR: STEADY INCOME EARNERS
Start with last month's actual spending and adjust up or down. Easy to maintain once you have a few months of data. Works well for stable income.	

There is no single "right" way to budget. The best method is the one you will actually stick with.

Expense Category Guide

Organize your spending for clarity

Housing	Rent/Mortgage • Property Tax • Home Insurance • HOA • Repairs • Utilities (gas, electric, water, trash)
Transportation	Car Payment • Auto Insurance • Fuel • Maintenance • Registration • Public Transit • Parking • Rideshare
Food & Groceries	Groceries • Dining Out • Coffee • Work Lunches • Snacks • Delivery • Alcohol
Insurance & Health	Health Insurance • Life Insurance • Dental • Vision • Co-pays • Prescriptions • Gym • Therapy
Debt Payments	Credit Cards • Student Loans • Personal Loans • Medical Debt • IRS/ Tax Debt • Buy-Now-Pay-Later
Subscriptions	Streaming • Phone • Internet • Software • Memberships • Magazines • Cloud Storage • Apps
Personal & Lifestyle	Clothing • Haircut/Beauty • Personal Care • Education • Hobbies • Gifts • Kids Activities
Entertainment	Movies • Concerts • Events • Hobbies • Books • Games • Sports • Travel • Nights Out
Savings & Investments	Emergency Fund • Retirement (401k/IRA) • Brokerage • College Fund • Sinking Funds • Vacation Fund

Financial Goals

Clear goals make every dollar purposeful

SMART GOALS

Specific • Measurable • Achievable • Relevant • Time-bound. "Save more" is a wish. "Save \$5,000 for an emergency fund by December" is a goal.

SHORT-TERM (THIS YEAR)

MID-TERM (1–5 YEARS)

LONG-TERM (5+ YEARS)

MY #1 PRIORITY THIS YEAR

GOAL

AMOUNT

BY WHEN

Annual Financial Overview

Your roadmap for the year ahead

MONTH	INCOME	EXPENSES	SAVED	NET
January				
February				
March				
April				
May				
June				
July				
August				
September				
October				
November				
December				
TOTAL				

YEAR'S FOCUS

01

PART ONE

Monthly Budgets

12 months — plan, track, and adjust

January Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

January Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME

EXPENSES

REMAINING

MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

February Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

February Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

March Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

March Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

April Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

April Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME

EXPENSES

REMAINING

MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

May Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

May Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

June Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

June Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

July Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

July Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME

EXPENSES

REMAINING

MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

August Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

August Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

September Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

September Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

October Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

October Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

November Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

November Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME

EXPENSES

REMAINING

MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

December Budget

Plan your income and allocate your spending

INCOME

SOURCE	PLANNED (\$)	ACTUAL (\$)
Primary Salary		
Secondary / Side		
Freelance / Bonus		
Investment / Other		
Total Income		

PLANNED EXPENSES

CATEGORY	PLANNED (\$)
Housing / Rent	
Utilities	
Groceries	
Dining Out	
Transportation	
Insurance	
Debt Payments	
Subscriptions	
Personal / Lifestyle	
Entertainment	
Savings / Investment	
Other	
Total Expenses	

December Tracker

Record actual spending and review your month

ACTUAL EXPENSES

CATEGORY	ACTUAL (\$)	DIFF (\$)
Housing / Rent		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Dining Out		
Transportation		
Insurance		
Debt Payments		
Subscriptions		
Personal / Lifestyle		
Entertainment		
Savings / Investment		
Other		
Total Actual		

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
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MONTH REFLECTION

What went well?

What to improve next month?

02

PART TWO

Weekly Expense Tracking

Log every purchase

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

Weekly Expense Tracker

Log every purchase to see where your money goes

DAY	DESCRIPTION	CATEGORY	AMOUNT
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			
Total			

03

PART THREE

Savings Goals

Watch your progress grow

Savings Goals Tracker

Visualize your path to each milestone

Emergency Fund (3–6 months expenses)

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Vacation / Travel Fund

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Home Down Payment

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Vehicle / Car Fund

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Home Repair / Improvement

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Christmas / Holiday Gifts

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Education / Course Fund

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

Retirement Supplement

TARGET SAVED BY DATE

PROGRESS

04

PART FOUR

Debt Payoff

Snowball your way to freedom

Debt Payoff Tracker

List debts smallest to largest. Pay minimums on all, attack the smallest with everything extra.

Debt #1

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #2

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #3

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #4

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #5

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #6

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #7

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

Debt #8

PAID ☐

CREDITOR BALANCE RATE % MIN PAY

PAYOFF PROGRESS

05

PART FIVE

Bills & Net Worth

Stay on top of recurring payments

Bills & Subscription Tracker

Never miss a payment or forget a subscription

#	BILL / SUBSCRIPTION	DUE DAY	AMOUNT	FREQ.	AUTO?	✓
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						

Freq: M=Monthly, Q=Quarterly, A=Annually, W=Weekly | Auto: Y/N

Net Worth Statement

Your financial snapshot

ASSETS (WHAT YOU OWN)

ASSET	AMOUNT (\$)
Cash / Checking	
Savings Account	
Investment / Brokerage	
Retirement (401k / IRA)	
Home Value	
Vehicle(s)	
Other Assets	
Total Assets	

LIABILITIES (WHAT YOU OWE)

LIABILITY	AMOUNT (\$)
Mortgage	
Auto Loan	
Credit Card Debt	
Student Loans	
Personal Loans	
Medical Debt	
Other Debt	
Total Liabilities	

NET WORTH (ASSETS – LIABILITIES)	\$
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06

PART SIX

Year-End Review

Reflect and plan ahead

Year-End Financial Review

Celebrate progress and plan the year ahead

TOTAL SAVED

DEBT PAID OFF

NET WORTH CHANGE

BIGGEST FINANCIAL WIN THIS YEAR

BIGGEST LESSON LEARNED

GOALS FOR NEXT YEAR

07

PART SEVEN

Notes

Ideas, reminders, and planning

Ideas, reminders, and planning

Financial Notes

Ideas, reminders, and planning

Ideas, reminders, and planning

Financial Notes

Ideas, reminders, and planning